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THE EV-O-L OF L-O-V-E: HAVE LOVE LETTERS EVOLVED?

Dublin Core

Title

The E-V-O-L of L-O-V-E: Have Love Letters Evolved?

Description

Do you heart love letters? We do too! Fall into this collection with us and explore how one of humanity's most intimate expressions has evolved over time and across cultures. As society adapts to new technologies, undergoes urbanization, and repositions common values, love letters shift with the zeitgeist. They mirror the desires, the hopes, and the anxieties of their place in time. From handwritten declarations sealed with wax to singing telegrams delivered through the digital ether, each confession is a snapshot of the world that shaped it, join us in discovering how love finds a way to speak, no matter the era.

Content Warning: The E-V-O-L of L-O-V-E: Have Love Letters Evolved? Collection contains materials that may be upsetting or offensive to some users. The materials within may include language or imagery of a sexual nature, and personal or intimate sentiments. The thoughts expressed in these materials are solely those of the creators and do not represent the thoughts or opinions of the librarians and information professionals that assembled this collection.

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Collection Items

101 love letters

An analog floppy disk containing 101 Love Letters. 101 Love Letters software for Windows 3.1 by Great Bear Technology 3.5" HD floppy disk image, 1995.

Walt Whitman to Peter Doyle, 9 October [1868]

Ramona poet Walt Whitman's correspondence with long-term partner and lover Peter Doyle, who was a working class transit worker. The letter is largely filled with hints of affection, illustrating the day-to-day realities of "subversive" love...

Moses Soyer letter to David Soyer

This is a handwritten letter with doodles in color markers, from Moses Soyer to David Soyer. The assumption is that it is a correspondence between brothers. Moses expresses his and his cat's sadness at his brother's departure.

The love song of Shu-Sin

Article from the World History Encyclopedia which includes a translation and video tour of the tablet of the Love Song of Shu-Sin, considered to be the oldest love letter in existence. Shu Sin lived in ancient Mesopotamia, where he was the addressee...

I love my wife, my wife is dead

A letter from Richard Feynman, famous American physicist, to his deceased wife. The letter shows how love defies reason, physical time, and space.

Love and lollipops

Six sixth grade students write to Albert Einstein to lovingly inquire about what might happen to the living things on Earth if the Sun burnt out. Einstein provides a candid reply.

I just miss you, in a quite simple desperate human way

Vita Sackville-West pens a letter on January 21, 1926 to her lover, 20th century English author Virginia Woolf, while travelling by train from London to Persia to return to her diplomat husband.

"Love Letters"

In this short documentary film, directed by Tara Pallau and produced by HALAL Films, five young adults read their intimate love letters aloud and share the reasons they wrote the letter and whether or not they were effective.

Fannie addresses a letter to her husband

On December 26th, 1862, hoping to reconnect, a woman named Fannie writes to her husband, Mr. Norfleet Perry, whom she was separated from through domestic slave trade.

Love is as love does

A love letter selected from The Black Love Letters Project from Natalie Johnson to Aunt Marge.

View all 27 items

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This site presents digital collections built by graduate students in the Winter 2026 Digital Libraries class in the Library and Information Science (LIS) program at the University of Denver.

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